



1. Using Windows Event Viewer (Most Accurate Method)

Steps:

1. Press **Win + R** → **eventvwr.msc**
2. Navigate to:

Windows Logs → Security

Important Event IDs

Event ID	Meaning
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4624	Successful login
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4625	Failed login attempt
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4634	Logoff
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4647	User initiated logoff
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4672	Admin login with elevated privileges
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4776	Login using NTLM
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4800/4801	Workstation locked/unlocked
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Filter Only Login Logs

Right panel → **Filter Current Log**

Enter these IDs:

4624, 4625, 4634, 4647, 4672, 4776



2. Using PowerShell Commands

List Successful Logins

Get-EventLog -LogName Security -InstanceId 4624 | Select TimeGenerated, Message

List Failed Logins

Get-EventLog -LogName Security -InstanceId 4625 | Select TimeGenerated, Message

Find Admin Logins

Get-EventLog -LogName Security -InstanceId 4672



3. Using Command Prompt

Last Logged-In Users

whoami /user

Authentication history

net user USERNAME

Shows:

- Last logon
- Password change
- Login restrictions



4. Using Local Security Policy (Audit Logs Must Be Enabled)

If login logs are missing, you must **enable auditing**:

1. Press **Win + R** → **secpol.msc**
2. Go to:

Local Policies → Audit Policy

Enable:

- **Audit logon events**
- **Audit account logon events**



5. Using Windows Registry (Forensics Level)

Last Logged-In User

HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Authentication\LogonUI
Login timestamps

HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\ProfileList
Registry does NOT show all login attempts but supports timeline reconstruction.



6. Using Third-Party Forensic Tools

Best for deep investigations:

Tools:

- ELK/EZ Tools (EvtxECmd, Event Viewer parsers)
- FTK Imager
- KAPE + EvtxECmd
- Autopsy

They show:

- All login attempts
- Deleted logs
- Corrupted log recovery



7. Using WMI Query (Remote Login Tracking)

Get-WmiObject -Class Win32_LoggedOnUser



Summary (Easy to Remember)

Method	Best For
Event Viewer (4624, 4625)	Full login history
PowerShell	Quick extraction
CMD (net user)	Last login
Registry	Forensics timeline
SIEM / Tools	Advanced investigations